

ServiceNow Client-Side GlideUser (g_user)

Detailed Meanings, Scenarios, and Client Code Examples

This detailed guide describes every property and method on the client-side `g_user` object, detailing when to use them and how they are implemented in Client Scripts.

1. Properties (Static Values)

`g_user.firstName`

Meaning: The first name string of the current user record.

When to use: Personalized greeting banner notifications on load.

Client Script Example:

```
function onLoad() {  
    var fName = g_user.firstName;  
    g_form.addInfoMessage('Hello ' + fName + '! Please complete mandatory fields.');
```

`g_user.lastName`

Meaning: The last name string of the current user record.

When to use: Creating audit trails or logging debug lines.

Client Script Example:

```
function onSubmit() {  
    jslog('Form submission initiated by family name: ' + g_user.lastName);  
    return true;  
}
```

g_user.userID

Meaning: The 32-character database sys_id of the current user record. (A property, not a method).

When to use: Comparing reference fields (like Caller or Assignee) against the current logged-in user.

Client Script Example:

```
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading, isTemplate) {
    if (isLoading || newValue === '') return;

    var currentUserId = g_user.userID;
    if (newValue === currentUserId) {
        g_form.showFieldMsg('assigned_to', 'Assigned to yourself.', 'info');
    }
}
```

g_user.userName

Meaning: The login username of the current user (e.g. 'admin').

When to use: Matching specific system IDs or developer logging rules.

Client Script Example:

```
function onLoad() {
    if (g_user.userName === 'admin') {
        g_form.addErrorMessage('WARNING: You are in an ADMIN session.');
```

2. Methods (Functions)

g_user.getFullName()

Meaning: Combines first name and last name into a single display name string.

When to use: Setting default short descriptions or ticket summary lines.

Client Script Example:

```
function onLoad() {
    if (g_form.isNewRecord()) {
        var name = g_user.getFullName();
        g_form.setValue('short_description', 'Request opened by: ' + name + ' - ');
    }
}
```

g_user.hasRole(roleName)

Meaning: Checks if the user has the role. System Administrators automatically return true.

When to use: Standard field visibility controls where Admins should also get permissions.

Client Script Example:

```
function onLoad() {
  if (g_user.hasRole('itil')) {
    g_form.setDisplay('assignment_group', true);
  } else {
    g_form.setDisplay('assignment_group', false);
  }
}
```

g_user.hasRoleExactly(roleName)

Meaning: Checks explicit role assignment. Does not bypass check for Administrators.

When to use: Strict security and overrides where Admins should not have access by default.

Client Script Example:

```
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading, isTemplate) {
  if (isLoading || newValue === '') return;

  var hasAccess = g_user.hasRoleExactly('security_admin');
  if (newValue === 'true' && !hasAccess) {
    g_form.setValue('u_secure_override', false);
    g_form.addErrorMessage('Aborted: Requires security_admin role explicitly.');
```

g_user.hasRoles()

Meaning: Checks if the user is assigned any roles (excluding 'public').

When to use: Distinguishing internal fulfillers from external end-users (Service Portal).

Client Script Example:

```
function onLoad() {
  if (g_user.hasRoles()) {
    g_form.setSectionDisplay('internal_notes', true);
  } else {
    g_form.setSectionDisplay('internal_notes', false);
  }
}
```

g_user.hasRoleFromList(rolesList)

Meaning: Accepts a comma-separated list of roles and checks if the user has any of them.

When to use: Workspaces shared across multiple departments (e.g. ITIL, Asset Managers).

Client Script Example:

```
function onLoad() {
  var isFulfiller = g_user.hasRoleFromList('asset, catalog_admin, itil');
  if (isFulfiller) {
    g_form.setDisplay('u_assignment_group', true);
  } else {
    g_form.setDisplay('u_assignment_group', false);
  }
}
```